

Word family: **senior / seniors / seniority**

Base word: senior

Plural noun: seniors

Related forms: seniority

Useful constructions/extensions: senior manager, senior staff, senior position, senior role, senior to someone, senior citizen, senior student, senior year, senior team, senior level, seniority

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞)

Your passage contains:

> “I had to speak in front of about two hundred colleagues and several **senior managers**.”

Here, **senior** means:

higher in rank, authority, responsibility, or organizational position.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **senior managers**

senior describes managers who hold **higher-ranking or more responsible positions** within the company.

It does **not** simply mean they are older in age.

Meaning: Having a relatively high position, level of authority, responsibility, or experience within an organization.

繁體中文: **在公司或機構內職級較高、權責較大或資歷較深的**

中文翻譯:

> “I had to speak in front of about two hundred colleagues and several senior managers.”

「我當時要在大約二百位同事和幾位**高層／高級經理**面前發言。」

So:

senior manager = 在公司管理架構中職級較高、責任和決策權較大的經理

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

1. **senior + job/position/title (職位／職級) — 高級的; 資深的; 高層的**

This is the exact meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: Holding a relatively high rank, responsibility, or authority within an organization or profession.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I had to speak in front of several **senior managers**.”

「我要在幾位**高層／高級經理**面前發言。」

Practice 2

> “She was promoted to a **senior position** last year.”

「她去年獲晉升到一個**較高級的職位**。」

Practice 3

> “The decision must be approved by **senior management**.”

「這項決定必須得到**高層管理人員／高層管理層**批准。」

senior + role/title = 在機構架構中職級較高、權責較大或資歷較深的

Common:

- * senior manager
- * senior executive
- * senior engineer
- * senior consultant
- * senior officer
- * senior staff

2. **senior staff/management (高層／資深員工) — 高層人員; 資深員工**

Practice 4

> “Several members of ****senior staff**** attended the event.”

「幾位****高層／資深職員****出席了活動。」

Practice 5

> “The issue was discussed by ****senior management****.”

「這個問題由****高層管理層****討論。」

****senior staff/management = 在組織中擁有較高職級、較大責任或決策權的人員****

Natural Chinese depends on context:

* 高層

* 高級職員

* 資深員工

* 高層管理人員

3. ****senior = more experienced / advanced professionally (資深的) — 資深的; 經驗較多的****

Here the emphasis is not only formal rank, but also professional experience.

Practice 6

> “She is a ****senior lawyer**** with twenty years of experience.”

「她是一位有二十年經驗的****資深律師****。」

Practice 7

> “A ****senior engineer**** reviewed the design.”

「一位****資深工程師****審核了設計。」

****senior = 在某個專業領域中經驗較多、地位較高或承擔更複雜責任的****

This often overlaps with organizational rank.

4. ****senior to + person (職級較高) — 比……資深／職級高****

A useful grammatical pattern.

Practice 8

> “She is **senior to me** in the department.”

「她在部門裡**職級比我高／比我資深**。」

Practice 9

> “Several employees are **senior to him**.”

「有幾名員工的**職級比他高**。」

be senior to someone = 在職級、資歷或組織地位上高於某人

Important grammar:

>  senior **to** someone

not normally:

>  senior than someone

This is a very useful learner point.

5. **senior = older in age (年長的) — 年長的; 較年長的**

A different core meaning.

Practice 10

> “He is five years **senior to** me.”

「他**比我年長五歲**。」

Practice 11

> “She is the **senior** member of the family.”

「她是家庭中**較年長的一位**。」

****senior = 年齡比另一人較大／較年長的****

This use is more formal than simply:

> older

6. ****someone's senior (比某人年長的人) — 比某人年長的人****

Here ****senior**** is a noun.

Practice 12

> “He married a woman ten years his ****senior****.”

「他娶了一位****比他年長十歲****的女性。」

Practice 13

> “She is several years my ****senior****.”

「她****比我年長幾歲****。」

****someone's senior = 年齡比某人較大的人****

This is formal and often used with an age difference.

7. ****senior = higher school/university level (高年級的) — 高年級的; 畢業班的****

A major educational meaning.

Practice 14

> “She teaches ****senior students****.”

「她教****高年級學生****。」

Practice 15

> “The school offers advanced courses for ****senior pupils****.”

「學校為**高年級學生**提供進階課程。」

senior student/pupil = 在學校或教育制度中處於較高年級／較高階段的學生

The exact meaning varies by educational system.

8. **senior year(畢業前最後一年／高年級) — 高中／大學最後一年**

Especially common in American English.

Practice 16

> “She is in her **senior year** of college.”

「她正在讀大學**最後一年／四年級**。」

Practice 17

> “He started applying for jobs during his **senior year**.”

「他在大學**最後一年**開始求職。」

senior year = 在美式教育制度中, 高中或大學本科階段的最後一年

This is a regional educational use.

9. **a senior(高年級學生) — 畢業班學生／高年級學生**

Also especially common in American English.

Practice 18

> “She is a **senior** in high school.”

「她是高中**畢業班學生／十二年級學生**。」

Practice 19

> “Most **seniors** are preparing for graduation.”

「大部分**畢業班學生**都正在準備畢業。」

****a senior = 美國教育制度中處於高中／大學最後一年級的學生****

10. ****senior citizen (長者) — 長者; 老年人****

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 20

> “The museum offers discounts for ****senior citizens****.”

「博物館為****長者****提供優惠。」

Practice 21

> “The programme provides transport for ****senior citizens****.”

「這個計劃為****長者／老年人****提供交通服務。」

****senior citizen = 年紀較大、通常已達退休年齡或被社會視為長者的人****

This is generally more polite/formal than:

> old person

11. ****senior = adult/older category in sport (成年／高級組別) — 成人組; 高級組****

A common sports meaning.

Practice 22

> “She now competes at ****senior level****.”

「她現在參加****成人組／高級組****比賽。」

Practice 23

> “He made his debut for the ****senior team****.”

「他首次代表**成年隊／一隊**上陣。」

senior = 比青年／少年級別更高, 通常指成人最高主要競賽層級

Contrast:

* junior team

* senior team

12. **senior team (成年隊／一隊) — 一隊; 成人代表隊**

Practice 24

> “She was promoted from the youth team to the **senior team**.”

「她由青年隊升上**一隊／成年隊**。」

Practice 25

> “He has played ten matches for the **senior team**.”

「他已經為**一隊**上陣十場。」

senior team = 某球會／組織中主要成人競賽隊伍, 而不是青年隊

13. **senior level (高級／最高層級) — 高層級; 高級別**

This works beyond sport.

Practice 26

> “She has experience working at a **senior level**.”

「她有在**高層級職位**工作的經驗。」

Practice 27

> “The issue requires discussion at **senior level**.”

「這個問題需要由**高層級人員**討論。」

senior level = 在組織、專業或競賽體系中較高的層級

Context determines whether it means:

- * 高層管理級
- * 高級專業級
- * 成人／最高競賽級

14. **seniority = higher status based on rank/length of service (資歷／年資) — 資歷; 年資; 優先地位**

An important related noun.

Practice 28

> “Promotion is partly based on **seniority**.”

「晉升部分取決於**年資／資歷**。」

Practice 29

> “She has greater **seniority** than most members of the team.”

「她比團隊大部分成員擁有更高的**資歷／年資**。」

seniority = 因職級較高或服務年期較長而取得的地位、優先權或資歷

15. **seniority = length of service (年資) — 服務年期; 年資**

More specifically:

Practice 30

> “Employees with more **seniority** can choose their holidays first.”

「**年資較長**的員工可以優先選擇假期。」

Practice 31

> “His pay reflects his years of **seniority**.”

「他的薪酬反映了他的**服務年資**。」

seniority = 某人在機構中任職／服務的時間長短, 尤其當年資影響權利或待遇時

16. **seniority** = rank precedence (職級優先次序) — 資歷／職位高低

Practice 32

> “Decisions are sometimes influenced by **seniority**.”

「有些決定會受到**職級／資歷高低**影響。」

Practice 33

> “She has **seniority over** the other managers.”

「她的**職級／資歷**高於**其他經理**。」

seniority = 在組織層級中因較高職位或較長資歷而具有的優先地位

17. **senior member** (資深／年長成員) — 資深成員; 年長成員

This is context-sensitive.

Practice 34

> “She is one of the **senior members** of the team.”

「她是團隊其中一位**資深成員**。」

Practice 35

> “The club provides support for its **senior members**.”

「會社為其**年長會員**提供支援。」

senior member can mean:

1. higher-ranking / more experienced member;
2. older member.

Context must decide.

18. **senior partner(高級合夥人／資深合夥人) — 資深合夥人**

Common in law, accounting, consulting, etc.

Practice 36

> “The case was reviewed by a **senior partner**.”

「案件由一位**資深合夥人**審核。」

Practice 37

> “She became a **senior partner** at the firm.”

「她成為該公司的**高級／資深合夥人**。」

senior partner = 在合夥制專業機構中地位、資歷或責任較高的合夥人

19. **senior executive(高層行政人員) — 高級主管; 高層管理人員**

Practice 38

> “Several **senior executives** attended the presentation.”

「幾位**高層主管**出席了簡報。」

Practice 39

> “The proposal was reviewed by **senior executives**.”

「提案由**高層管理人員**審核。」

senior executive = 在企業中擁有較高管理和決策責任的主管

20. **senior leadership (高層領導) — 高層領導層**

Practice 40

> “The issue has been raised with **senior leadership**.”

「這個問題已向**高層領導層**反映。」

Practice 41

> “Support from **senior leadership** is essential.”

「**高層領導**的支持非常重要。」

senior leadership = 一個機構中最高或較高層級的領導／決策人員

21. **senior role (高階職位) — 高級職位; 高層角色**

Practice 42

> “She is ready for a more **senior role**.”

「她已經準備好擔任一個**更高級的職位**。」

Practice 43

> “He moved into a **senior role** in finance.”

「他轉到財務部擔任一個**高階職位**。」

senior role = 在組織中具有較大責任、影響力或決策權的職位

22. **senior figure (資深／重要人物) — 高層人物; 重要人物**

Practice 44

> “A **senior figure** in the organization spoke to the media.”

「機構內一名**高層人物**向傳媒發言。」

Practice 45

> “Several **senior figures** supported the proposal.”

「幾位**重要高層人物**支持這項提案。」

senior figure = 在某個機構、領域或群體中地位較高、較具影響力的人

Important distinction: senior = higher rank vs senior = older

This is the most important contrast.

Rank:

> “She is a **senior manager**.”

= 她是一位**高級／高層經理**。

This does not necessarily mean she is old.

Age:

> “He is five years **senior to me**.”

= 他**比我年長五歲**。

So:

senior — workplace = 職級／資歷較高

senior — age = 年齡較大

Context is essential.

Important distinction: senior vs older

older

is the normal everyday comparative for age:

> “She is older than me.”

「她比我年長。」

senior

can also express age difference, but sounds more formal:

> “She is three years my senior.”

「她比我年長三歲。」

For ordinary conversation, **older** is usually simpler.

Important distinction: **senior to vs older than**

Grammar differs.

Senior:

>  “She is **senior to** me.”

Older:

>  “She is **older than** me.”

Avoid:

>  senior than me

So:

senior to

but:

older than

Important distinction: **senior vs experienced**

These overlap but are not identical.

senior

often indicates:

- * organizational rank;
- * professional level;
- * responsibility;
- * sometimes experience.

experienced

specifically means:

> having substantial experience.

A person can be:

> **highly experienced but not senior**

if they have long experience but do not hold a high-ranking role.

Likewise, someone might receive a **senior title** even if another employee has more total years of experience.

So:

senior = 職級／專業層級較高

experienced = 經驗豐富

Important distinction: **senior vs seniority**

senior

describes a person/position:

> “a senior manager”

= 高級經理

seniority

is a noun referring to:

- * higher rank;
- * greater length of service;
- * precedence based on those factors.

> “Promotion depends on seniority.”

= 晉升取決於資歷／年資。

Important distinction: **senior manager vs senior management**

senior manager

= one person holding a relatively high management position

senior management

= the group of higher-ranking managers collectively

> “I spoke to a senior manager.”

= 我跟一位高級經理交談。

> “The decision came from senior management.”

= 這項決定來自高層管理層。

Important distinction: **senior staff vs older staff**

senior staff

usually means:

> higher-ranking / more experienced employees

older staff

means:

> employees who are greater in age.

These are not interchangeable.

> “The meeting was attended by senior staff.”

does not mean:

> ❌ 年紀較大的員工出席了會議

It usually means:

> ✅ 高層／較高職級員工出席了會議

Important distinction: **senior citizen vs senior employee**

senior citizen

= 長者／老年人

senior employee

= 職級較高或資歷較深的員工

A **senior employee** may be relatively young.

A **senior citizen** refers to age.

Important distinction: **senior student vs senior citizen**

senior student

can mean:

* higher-year student;

* in American usage, final-year high-school/university student.

senior citizen

= older person.

So ****senior**** changes according to the hierarchy being described:

- * organizational hierarchy;
- * age hierarchy;
- * educational level;
- * sports level.

Important distinction: **senior vs junior******

This is the central contrast.

Workplace:

> senior manager

> = 高級經理

> junior manager / junior employee

> = 初級經理／較低職級員工

Age:

> senior to me

> = 比我年長

> junior to me

> = 比我年幼／資歷較淺

Sport:

> senior team

> = 成年隊／一隊

> junior team

> = 青年／少年隊

Education:

> senior students

> = 高年級學生

> junior students

> = 較低年級學生

So **senior/junior** express **relative level**, but the type of level depends on context.

Important distinction: **senior team vs first team**

In sport, these often overlap but are not always identical.

**senior team**

contrasts mainly with:

> youth / junior teams

**first team**

usually means:

> the club's primary competitive team

In many contexts the senior team is the first team, but the exact organizational structure can vary.

Important distinction: **senior year vs final year**

**senior year**

is especially American educational terminology.

**final year**

is broader and more internationally understandable.

> “She is in her final year at university.”

works across many English varieties.

For international learners:

****final year**** is often the safer general expression.

Important distinction: **senior vs superior**

These are not interchangeable.

**senior**

usually refers to:

- * rank;
- * experience;
- * age;
- * organizational level.

**superior**

can mean:

1. higher in rank;
2. better in quality.

> “a superior product”

= 品質較優越的產品

You cannot normally replace:

> “senior manager”

with:

> “superior manager”

because that could sound like:

> a better-quality manager

rather than a job title.

Important distinction: **senior vs high-level**

senior

is especially natural for people and roles:

- * senior manager
- * senior engineer
- * senior executive

high-level

is common for:

- * discussions;
- * meetings;
- * policy;
- * officials in certain contexts;
- * broad strategic concepts.

> high-level meeting

> = 高層會議

But:

> senior meeting

is generally not natural in the same meaning.

Collocation matters.

Register note: **senior citizen**

Senior citizen is widely understood and often used in:

- * discounts;
- * public services;
- * formal schemes.

However, in general prose, terms such as:

> older people

> older adults

may also be used depending on context and style.

The important lexical point is:

****senior citizen = 以年齡／人生階段分類的長者****

not:

****higher-ranking citizen****.

Family-extension sweep

The practical ****senior**** family is fairly compact morphologically, but semantically useful across several hierarchies:

* ****senior manager/executive**** = 高層／高級管理人員

* ****senior staff**** = 高層／較高職級員工

* ****senior position/role**** = 高階職位

* ****senior professional**** = 資深專業人士

* ****senior to someone — rank**** = 職級／資歷高於某人

* ****senior to someone — age**** = 年齡比某人大

* ****someone's senior**** = 比某人年長的人

* ****senior student**** = 高年級學生

* ****senior year**** = 高中／大學最後一年(美式)

* ****a senior — student**** = 畢業班／最後一年學生(美式)

* ****senior citizen**** = 長者

* ****senior team**** = 成年隊／一隊

* ****senior level**** = 高級別／成人級別／高層級

* ****senior partner**** = 資深／高級合夥人

* ****senior leadership**** = 高層領導層

* ****senior figure**** = 高層／有影響力的重要人物

* ****seniority — service**** = 年資

* ****seniority — rank**** = 資歷／職級優先地位

The underlying concept is broadly:

> ****higher on a relevant scale or hierarchy****

but that hierarchy may be:

* organizational rank;

- * professional experience;
- * age;
- * educational level;
- * sports category.

The Traditional Chinese translation therefore must adapt naturally.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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senior + job/title	在公司／機構中職級較高、權責較大或資歷較深的
senior staff/management	在組織中擁有較高職級、較大責任或決策權的人員／管理層
senior — professionally experienced	在某個專業領域中經驗、地位或責任較高的；資深的
senior to someone — rank	在職級、資歷或組織地位上高於某人
senior — age	年齡相對較大、較年長的
someone's senior	年齡比某人較大的人
senior student/pupil	在教育制度中處於較高年級／較高學習階段的學生
senior year	美式教育制度中高中或大學本科階段的最後一年
a senior — student	美國高中／大學最後一年級的學生
senior citizen	年紀較大、通常已達退休年齡或被視為長者的人
senior level — sport	比青年／少年級別更高、通常指成人主要競賽層級
senior team	某球會／組織中的主要成人競賽隊伍
senior level — organization	在組織、專業或管理架構中較高的層級
seniority — length of service	某人在機構中服務的年期及由此產生的年資
seniority — rank/precedence	因較高職位或較長資歷而具有的優先地位
senior member	視語境指較資深／較高地位，或較年長的成員
senior partner	在專業合夥機構中地位、資歷或責任較高的合夥人
senior executive	在企業中擁有較高管理和決策責任的高層主管
senior leadership	機構中較高／最高層級的領導及決策人員
senior role	在組織中擁有較大責任、影響力或決策權的高階職位
senior figure	在某個機構、領域或群體中地位較高、具較大影響力的人

For your original passage

> “I had to speak in front of about two hundred colleagues and several ****senior managers****.”

The exact meaning is:

****senior = 在公司管理架構中職級較高、責任和決策權較大的****

Therefore:

> **senior managers**

= **「高層／高級經理」**

The sentence does **not** tell us that these managers were older in age.

The important idea is organizational hierarchy:

> ordinary colleagues

> → managers

> → **senior managers**

The presence of **senior managers** increases the pressure because they are likely to have:

* higher organizational status;

* greater responsibility;

* greater decision-making authority;

* more influence within the company.

So the key mapping in your passage is:

senior manager = 公司內職級及權責較高的經理／高層經理

The most important learner contrasts are:

> **senior manager**

> = 高級／高層經理

> **senior employee**

> = 較高職級或較資深的員工

> **senior to me**

> = 職級／資歷高於我, 或在某些語境中比我年長

> **five years my senior**

> = 比我年長五歲

> **senior student**

> = 高年級學生

> **senior year**

> = 高中／大學最後一年(美式)

> **senior citizen**

> = 長者

> **senior team**

> = 成年隊／一隊

> **seniority**

> = 年資／資歷／職級優先地位

So **senior** should not be memorized simply as:

> **senior = 年長的**

In your passage, it means **higher-ranking within the company**, not older.